

HP TouchSmart IQ 508D

A Touch Is All I Need

With a glossy black body that is not more than 3 three inches thick and a small footprint, the HP Touchsmart PC IQ508D looks stylish and greatly economises on space by incorporating the traditional cabinet behind the monitor itself. The optical drive and ports are placed on the sides; neat design. Overall a very classy looking desktop.

The display on the Touchsmart is a 22-inch LCD panel having a native resolution of 1680 x 1050 pixels. The display is touch sensitive (hence the name TouchSmart) and supports Multi-Touch. If you are a big fan of Apple's multi-touch interface made famous by their iPod Touch PMPs you are definitely going to like it. But though quite big and responsive, the touch screen lacks precision, so it's bit difficult to work on smaller things like pop-up messages and notifications. Be prepared to clean it regularly though, as the screen picks up smudges.

Multimedia becomes serious fun with the ability to play videos, skip through movie clips and zoom in and out of photos or even watch TV; all with finger gestures on-screen.

Setting up monitor and other peripherals for this PC is extremely simple.

Apart from being a space saver, this PC features



onboard Bluetooth and Wi-Fi; something most desktops lack (if it is fair to call this a desktop!) for greater wire-free experience. However HP spoils the whole wire-free design by bundling a big and bulky power adapter with it throwing in a huge power adapter. We would have loved to see an onboard power supply considering heavy weight of this computer and also this would have significantly enhanced its space saver design.

For input devices other than the touch screen, this PC comes with a bundled wireless mouse and keyboard combo for smooth and comfortable operation. The keyboard and mouse are not very good in terms of ergonomics but are quite responsive otherwise, and if you love games and chat-

ting then you will not be disappointed by the performance of the mouse and the keyboard's tactile feedback.

This PC has 4 GB of DDR2 RAM, which allows it to handle several applications at the same time without affecting performance. It comes with a

7200 rpm, 500GB HDD to store all your favourite music, videos or anything you wish tothis should keep you satisfied for awhile.

Down to performance; PC Mark 05 score of 5189 is low for a Media Centre PC, but it is understandable given the fact that it has a Mobile processor in place of a Desktop processor for keeping its power consumption and heat output levels low.

As far as 3D performance is concerned, it may not be the best in league for a Media Centre PC, but still it performed quite well on our benchmarks scoring a total of 3342 in 3DMark 05 (Graphic intensive benchmark) and a maximum frame rate of 147 in *Far Cry* at 800 x 600 resolution, Medium with medium settings. Although this machine is not meant for gaming but it will not disappoint the occasional urge for some frags, or a few circuit laps.

Its onboard 4 watt speakers performed better than we thought they would, and are loud and clear. Although a little low on bass, the speakers performed well at different volume levels. Onboard audio is handled by Sound Max

HD integrated Digital audio controller that supports 5.1 channel sound output. This machine can also be connected to a home theatre system but only via SPDIF or optical connector as it does not have multichannel 3.5 mm connectors.

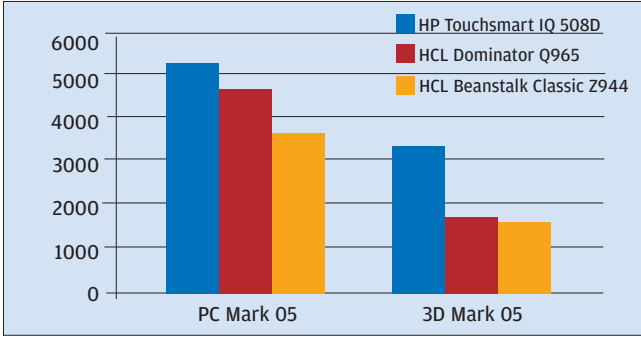
The TouchSmart IQ 508 D is priced at Rs 87,990. Essentially it is meant for home entertainment combining computing with entertainment and a new concept of having everything on a big touch sensitive screen but is it really worth spending that much? Our take is that the TouchSmart PC comes as a nice innovation from HP and makes computing more interactive and interesting. More importantly, it's more fun to have varied functionality, all built into a sleek and stylish body, without a cabinet. However, its high price tag might prevent most of us from considering this as a viable purchase. As with everything else tech, prices are bound to go down, so maybe it's best you wait for that.

Specifications

Intel C2D T5850 2.16 GHz, 4GB RAM DDR2 668 MHz, Nvidia 9300M GS Graphics Card (256MB), 500 GB HDD, Windows Vista Home Premium, 22inch touch sensitive display 1680 x 1050 resolution

Contact: HP
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Price: 87,990

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆



N85 8 GB

N95 8 GB Junior!

Nokia's has always been known for solid albeit unattractive phones. Their latest phones try to solve the latter issue, and the N series has been a forbearer in this regard. Their N85 8 GB follows the latest design trend of being sleek, compact and sports the same kind of glossy, two-tone finish that we've seen from the newer N series phones like the N78, N82 and such. While some like the new colours, others may prefer the suave black of the N95 8 GB to the glossy mocha brown of the N85 8 GB. We feel that looks aside, these new finishes are longer lasting; this is noticeable after months of regular use. The N85 8 GB is built like a small tank and feels extremely solid in hand; much better than the N95 8 GB; full points to Nokia here.

It's a really compact phone that is slim even while incorporating a two way slider which has a nice slick movement. The slider does develop a little play after awhile of use; just how bad this is we'll only know after three or four months of heavy usage which is impossible to test within the timeframe we had. The screen is OLED, a first for Nokia and measures 2.6-inches. We found this screen dimmer and the colours slightly darker than other Nokia LCD screens. The colours also seem a little saturated, and we feel there's a lot of work that needs to be done on OLED screens judging from this one before they can replace LCDs in high-end smartphones. The first serious complaint is with the call accept / reject buttons — they're too tiny for proper use. The joypad is

also a pain with a rather uncomfortable bezel around the middle button. This four-way button (bezel, whatever) is also hard to press and the menu buttons on either side of it sometimes get pressed when you use it. Conversely, the four-way button gets in the way of the menu buttons, unless you use your nails. The buttons are, however, well lit. The inner keypad is completely devoid of beveling and only has a thin raised surface between the three rows of keys; despite this the keypad is good mainly because the number keys are well laid out and exude positive feedback. SMS junkies will not be disappointed. The volume buttons on the side and the camera button are really well placed and very easy to use; once again button feedback is excellent and positive. There is a hold slider provided for disabling the keypad; a plus when traveling as this avoids accidental key presses. The multimedia buttons on the two-way slider also work well and their backlighting is good.

For the first time Nokia has offered a USB charger; and the data cable and a/c adapter both utilise the same port. The five megapixel camera has a nice cover with a smooth action slide-back. Nokia provides a dual-LED flash which is more powerful than the flash aboard the N95 8 GB. A 3.5-mm connector for the headset means you can hook up your own headphones; a trend we've seen more often from Nokia in recent times.

Music quality is good; and the N85 8 GB is a good phone to use as a music PMP; the screen does let



down for video playback; we like OLEDs; they save power, but this isn't acceptable at the cost of display quality. Although text quality is good; and the screen is very crisp yet multimedia is not the pleasure it should be. In-call quality is good; and the N85 8 GB didn't drop a single call during our test and maintained good voice quality on speaker phone and with the headset. The phone is fast; faster than the Nokia E66 which we tested this month; and with a 369 MHz ARM 11 processor we'd expect it to be; this is faster than the hardware on the Nokia N96 which is their flagship model. NGage games support is built in and the N85 8GB can be used horizontally with games; the multimedia buttons double as game control buttons — neat! Additional goodies like WLAN and A-GPS with Nokia Maps keep things interesting; expansion is provided via microSD; and the suffix 8 GB is a misnomer as this phone doesn't have 8 GB of inbuilt memory; although Nokia does provide an 8 GB microSD card.

The camera is quite good; although we've seen an eight megapixel unit from Samsung; this unit produces good photos with decent lighting even indoors although you need to fiddle with the manual settings to get the best out of it. With a large 1200 mAh battery expect battery life to be quite good. We tested it and measured it at five and a half hours which is really good; right up there with our best phones.

At a price of Rs 27,299 (MRP), the N85 8 GB is certainly expensive, but it's a lot of phone for the price. We did not like the flawed menu pad and joypad; we didn't really care for the OLED screen and this phone should have had at least a 2.8-inch display. Other than that there's very little to nitpick about. It's very well built and very compact for the features; and the price is certain to fall in a couple of months' time. Do bear in mind that it doesn't have any more features than Nokia's other phones like their N96, N82 and N95 8 GB; so you have no dearth of choice.

Read the full review online at www.thinkdigit.com

Specifications

Dual slider CPU — ARM 11 369 MHz, 85-MB inbuilt, Screen — 2.6-inches, 240 x 320 pixels, 16M colours, , WLAN, A-GPS inbuilt, 5.0-megapixel camera with dual LED flash, microSD expansion.

Contact: Nokia India Pvt. Ltd.
Phone: 011-30303838
Website: www.nokia.com
Price: 27,299

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★☆
Performance	★★★★☆
Build quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★☆